

Product Strategy Document - Template

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About this template

A Product Strategy answers two questions: should we build this, and is it worth it? It defines the opportunity, the target personas, the business case, and the high-level concept. It does not define detailed capabilities (that's the PRD) or technical approach (that's the technical design).

Owned by the product lead for the product or module. Read by the team that owns it, adjacent teams, and the GM of any solution it participates in.

Write a strategy document at the level where an investment decision is being made. If a module doesn't have its own budget justification, it doesn't need its own strategy doc. Its justification lives in the product-level strategy above it. Whether to call this a Product Strategy or a Module Strategy depends on the tier it covers. The document type is the same. The scope differs.

A product or module can participate in multiple solutions. The Product Strategy doesn't change based on which solution is being sold. It references each one for context.

This document is durable substrate. It changes when strategic direction shifts or the conceptual model changes. If detailed capabilities are shifting, update the PRD. If technical approach is shifting, update the technical design. Frequent revisions here suggest WHAT or HOW content has crept into a document that should hold only WHY.

Written for two audiences at once. The humans on the team. And the agents that will increasingly help plan and execute the work. Both need the same thing: short sections, dense per section, with explicit links to the Solution Strategy above and the PRD below.

For the larger framework this document sits inside, see the Product Development Hierarchy and Document Framework.

[Product / Solution / Module Name] — Product Strategy

Author: [Name] **Last Updated:** [Date] **Status:** Draft | In Review | Approved | Superseded

Product Hierarchy

[\[LINK\]](#) - See Link for Details

Level	Name
Solution	[e.g., Patient Engagement Solution]
Product	[e.g., Care Agent]
Module	[e.g., Digital Discharge Skill, if this strategy is module-level]

Scope of this document: [State which level of the hierarchy this strategy covers. A Solution-level strategy sets context for multiple Products. A Product-level strategy sets context for multiple Modules. A Module-level strategy sets context for a single PRD.]

Related Documents

Document	Link
Parent Strategy	[Link to the strategy one level up, if this is Product- or Module-level]
PRD(s)	[Links to PRDs that implement this strategy, once created]
Market / Competitive Research	[Link, if separate document]
Customer Research / VOC	[Link to research, interviews, or survey data]

Executive Summary

Three to five sentences. State what this product or initiative is, what problem it solves, who it's for, and why it matters to the business. This should be readable by someone with no prior context and give them enough to decide whether to keep reading.

Opportunity

Why does this matter and why now? State the strategic opportunity in terms of market timing, customer demand, competitive positioning, or business model evolution. This is the big WHY: the reason this initiative exists and the cost of inaction.

Problem

What is broken, painful, or missing today? Be specific and concrete. Describe the problem from the perspective of the people who experience it. Use data where available: frequency, cost, time wasted, failure rates. If you have direct customer quotes that illustrate the problem, include them.

Avoid describing the problem in terms that presuppose your solution. "Clinics lack an AI-powered routing system" is a solution disguised as a problem. "Patients wait 90 minutes at one clinic while the location two miles away has immediate availability, and no one tells them" is a problem.

Evidence

What data, research, or customer input supports the problem and opportunity? Summarize key findings and link to detailed research documents where they exist. This section should answer: how confident are we that this problem is real and this opportunity is worth pursuing?

Objectives & Key Results

Define the strategic objectives this product supports and the measurable key results that indicate progress. OKRs should connect upward to company or portfolio-level goals. Individual PRDs will define feature-level success metrics that ladder up to these OKRs.

Objective 1: [Statement]

Key Result	Target	Timeline
[Measurable outcome]	[Specific target]	[Timeframe]
[Measurable outcome]	[Specific target]	[Timeframe]

Objective 2: [Statement]

Key Result	Target	Timeline
[Measurable outcome]	[Specific target]	[Timeframe]

Personas

Identify every persona who uses, buys, configures, or derives value from this product. For each persona, describe who they are, what they care about, and what success looks like for them. Be specific enough that someone writing a PRD can translate these personas into Target Users with clear needs.

Persona 1: [Name / Role]

Who they are: [Role, context, daily reality. Not demographics, but a description of their work and what drives their decisions.]

What they care about: [Their goals, pressures, and constraints. What keeps them up at night? What does their boss measure them on?]

How they relate to this product: [Are they the end user, the buyer, the administrator, the beneficiary? How do they encounter it?]

What success looks like: [If this product works perfectly, what changes for this persona? Be concrete.]

Persona 2: [Name / Role]

[Same structure. Repeat for each persona.]

Value Proposition

State the core value proposition in plain language. What does this product promise, to whom, and why should they believe it?

For each persona identified above, state the specific value they receive. Avoid generic claims ("improved efficiency"). Be specific enough to be falsifiable ("reduces document-related support calls by 60-80%").

For [Persona 1]:

- [Specific, measurable value statement]
- [Another]

For [Persona 2]:

- [Specific, measurable value statement]
- [Another]

Differentiation

What makes this different from alternatives the personas have today? This includes doing nothing, manual workarounds, and competitor products. State what is unique about this approach, not what is merely good about it.

Concept

Describe the product concept at a level sufficient to understand what's being proposed, without specifying detailed capabilities or features. This is the high-level WHAT: enough for a stakeholder to picture the product and evaluate whether the approach is sound, not enough for an engineer to build from. Detailed capabilities belong in the PRD.

Cover:

- What the product does, described in user terms
 - How it fits into the user's existing workflow or experience
 - What the experience feels like from the user's perspective
 - How it relates to other products in the portfolio (if applicable)
 - What it does NOT do (high-level boundaries)
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Business Model

How does this product generate or protect revenue? Be explicit about the economic model.

Pricing & Packaging

- [How is it priced? Per-unit, subscription, tiered, free/premium, bundled?]
- [Who pays? Is the buyer the same as the user?]
- [How does pricing relate to other products in the portfolio?]

Revenue Projections

Scenario	Year 1	Year 2	Year 3
Conservative			
Expected			
Optimistic			

Key assumptions: [State the assumptions behind the projections. Customer adoption rate, pricing, market size, etc.]

Strategic Value

If the primary value is not direct revenue (e.g., it's a free module that drives platform adoption, reduces churn, or enables upsell), state that explicitly. Quantify the indirect value where possible.

ROI Analysis

Provide the financial justification for investing in this product. This section should answer: is this worth building, and how long until we see returns?

Investment Required

Category	Estimate	Notes
Development		[Team size, duration, vendor costs if applicable]
Infrastructure		[Hosting, services, tooling]
Go-to-market		[Sales enablement, marketing, training]
Ongoing operations		[Annual run cost once live]

Expected Returns

Benefit	Annual Value	Basis
[e.g., New revenue from premium subscriptions]		[How this was calculated]
[e.g., Reduced churn / protected revenue]		

[e.g., Operational cost reduction for customers]		
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Payback period: [Expected time to positive ROI]

Sensitivity: [What would change the ROI significantly? What are the biggest financial risks?]

Go-to-Market

Target Market

- [Who are the initial target customers? Be specific about segments, size, geography, or other qualifying criteria.]
- [What is the total addressable market? Serviceable addressable market?]

Rollout Strategy

Phase	Audience	Goals	Entry Criteria
[e.g., Pilot]	[e.g., 3 selected customers]	[e.g., Validate core value prop, gather feedback]	[e.g., MVP complete, internal QA passed]
[e.g., Limited GA]	[e.g., Target segment]	[e.g., Prove scalability, refine pricing]	[e.g., Pilot OKRs met]
[e.g., General Availability]	[e.g., All eligible customers]	[e.g., Scale adoption, drive revenue]	[e.g., Limited GA metrics confirmed]

Sales & Enablement

- [How will the sales team position this? What training or materials do they need?]
- [Does this change the sales motion? New buyer, new conversation, or extension of existing relationship?]

Customer Communication

- [How will existing customers learn about this? Launch messaging, in-product discovery, account team outreach?]
 - [Is there a migration or transition path from an existing workflow?]
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Competitive Landscape

Summarize the competitive context. Who else solves this problem or serves these personas? What are their strengths and weaknesses relative to our approach? If a detailed competitive analysis exists as a separate document, summarize key findings and link to it.

Key Competitors

Competitor	Approach	Strengths	Weaknesses
[Name]	[Brief description of their solution]		
[Name]			
Status quo / manual workaround	[What people do today without any product]	[It's free, familiar]	[The problems described above]

Competitive Position

Where does this product sit relative to alternatives? What is our defensible advantage? Be honest about where competitors are stronger and what that means for positioning.

Product Risks

Risks related to market fit, adoption, competitive response, and product design. Not technical or implementation risks.

Risk	Likelihood	Impact	Mitigation
[e.g., Customers may not trust AI to redirect patients to	[H / M / L]	[Description]	[Product-level mitigation]

different locations]			
[e.g., Competitor launches similar capability with deeper integration]			
[e.g., Regulatory change restricts data sharing between clinic locations]			

Roadmap

High-level phasing of the product vision. Not a project timeline or sprint plan. This describes the sequence of value delivery: what comes first, what comes next, and what the end state looks like. Detailed timelines belong in project plans. Detailed capabilities belong in PRDs.

Phase 1: [Name]

Focus: [What this phase delivers and why it comes first] **Target Outcome:** [What success looks like at the end of this phase] **PRD(s):** [Link to PRD(s) covering this phase, once created]

Phase 2: [Name]

Focus: [What this phase adds] **Target Outcome:** [What success looks like] **PRD(s):** [Link]

Phase 3: [Name]

Focus: [What this phase adds] **Target Outcome:** [What success looks like] **PRD(s):** [Link]

Future State

Describe the long-term vision. What does this product look like in 2-3 years if everything goes well? This paints the picture that the phased roadmap is building toward.

Open Questions

Strategic questions that need resolution. These are higher-level than PRD open questions, which focus on specific capability decisions. Strategy-level questions affect the overall direction, business model, or positioning.

Question	Owner	Impact	Status
[e.g., Should this module be free (driving platform adoption) or premium (driving direct revenue)?]	[Decision maker]	[Affects business model, GTM, and competitive positioning]	Open / Resolved

Revision History

Date	Author	Change Summary
04/24/2026	Ian Lyman	Created

This document defines the strategic rationale, business case, and high-level concept for this product initiative. For detailed capability requirements, see the linked PRD(s). For technical approach and architecture, see the implementation plan(s). This strategy sets the context that PRDs are written within.